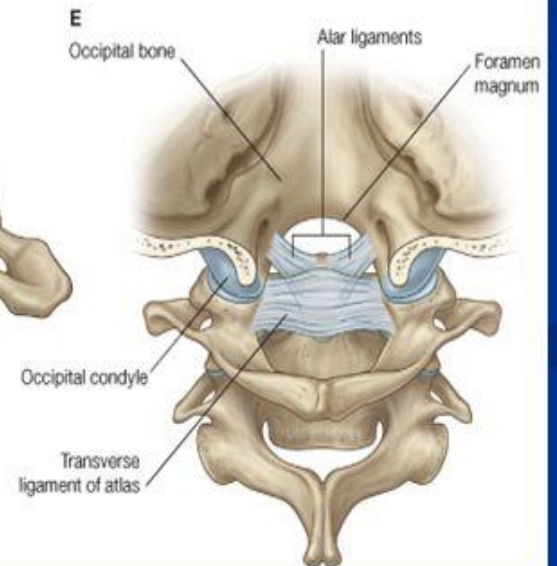
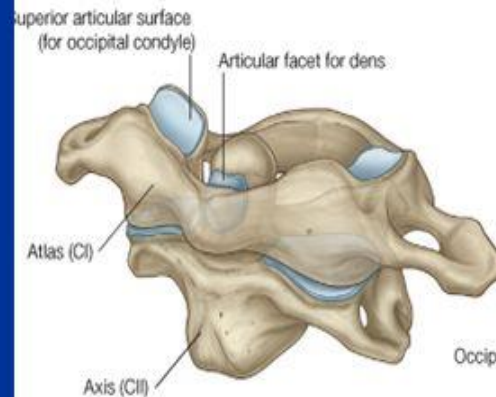
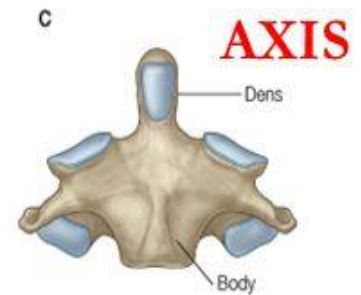
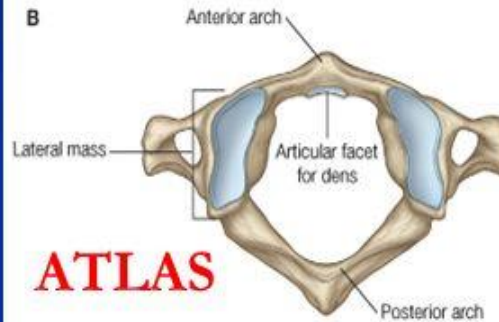
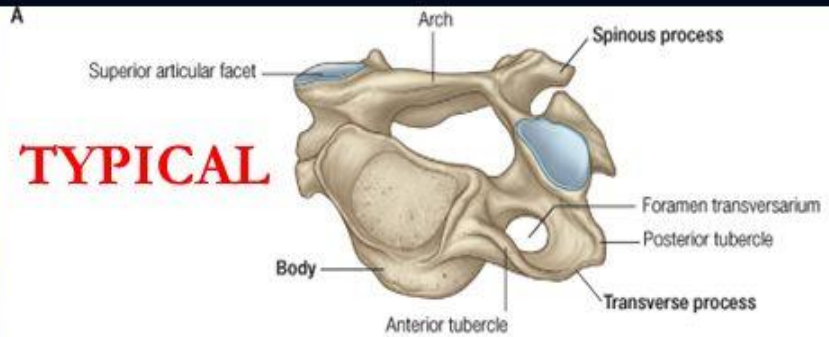


The Cervical Vertebrae

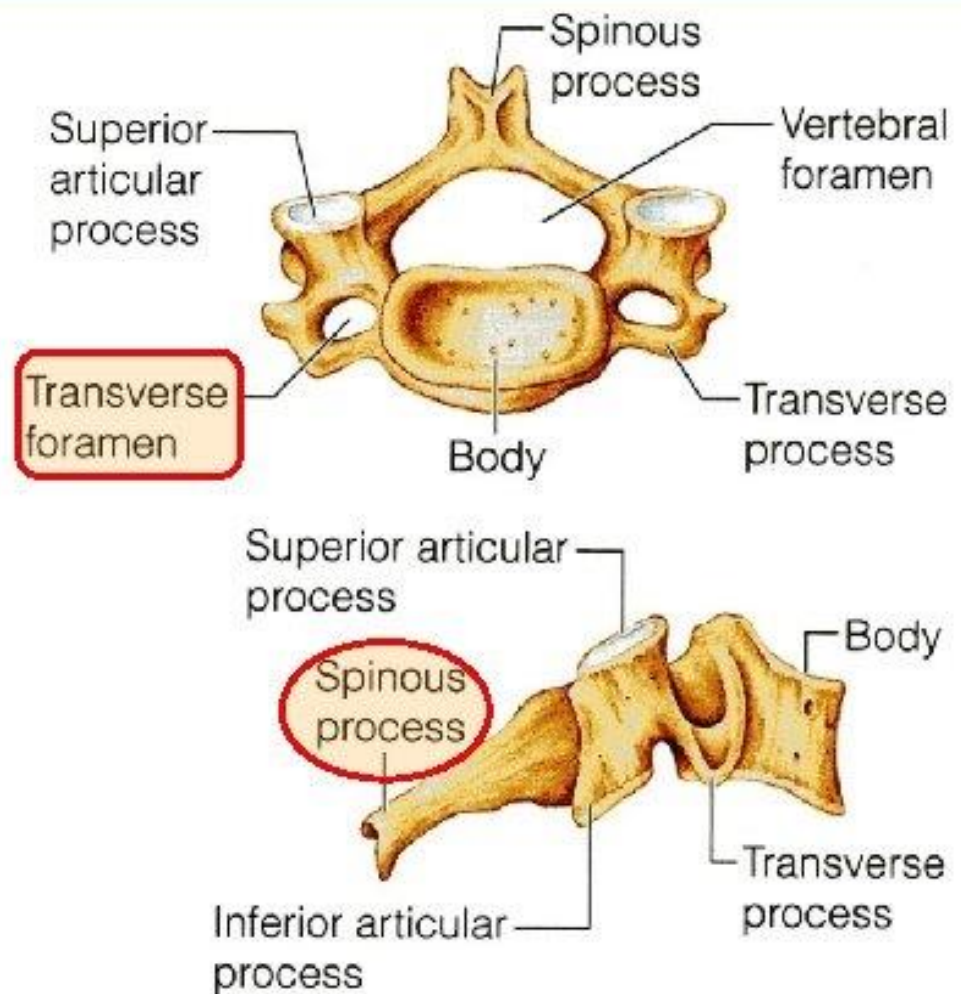


CERVICAL VERTEBRAE



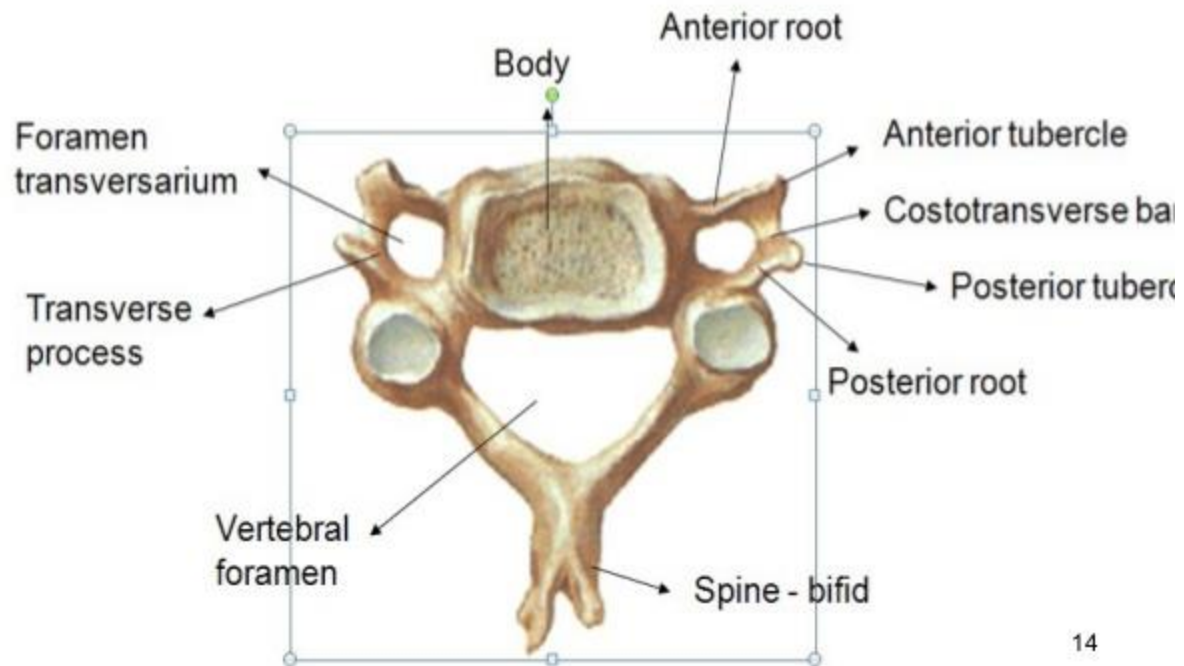
TYPICAL CERVICAL VERTEBRAE

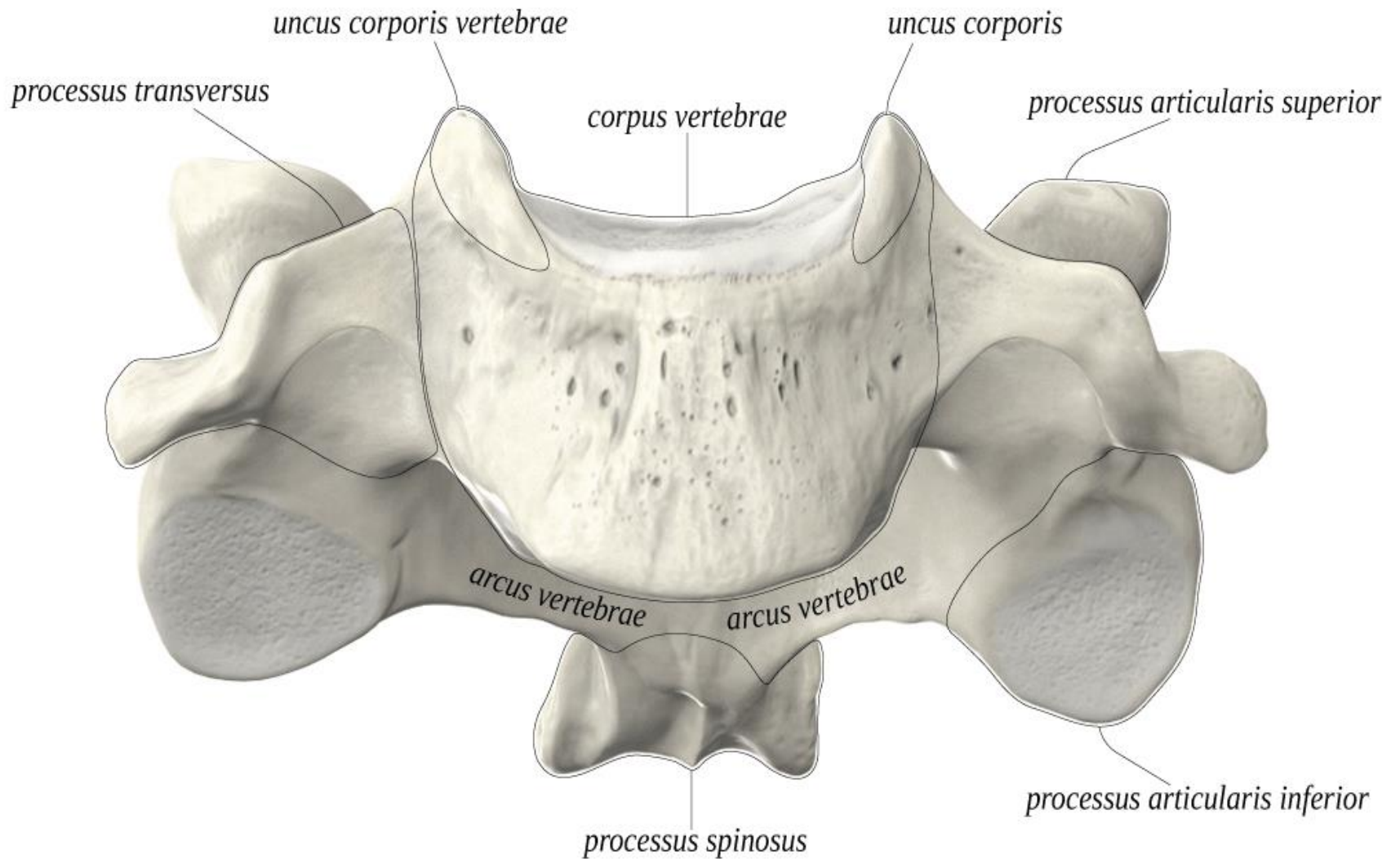
- The "typical" cervical vertebrae (C_3 to C_6) are the smallest, lightest vertebrae, and their **spinous processes** are short and bifid.
- The **transverse processes** of the cervical vertebrae contain **foramina** through which the vertebral **arteries** pass on their way to the brain above.



Cervical vertebrae

Typical cervical vertebra





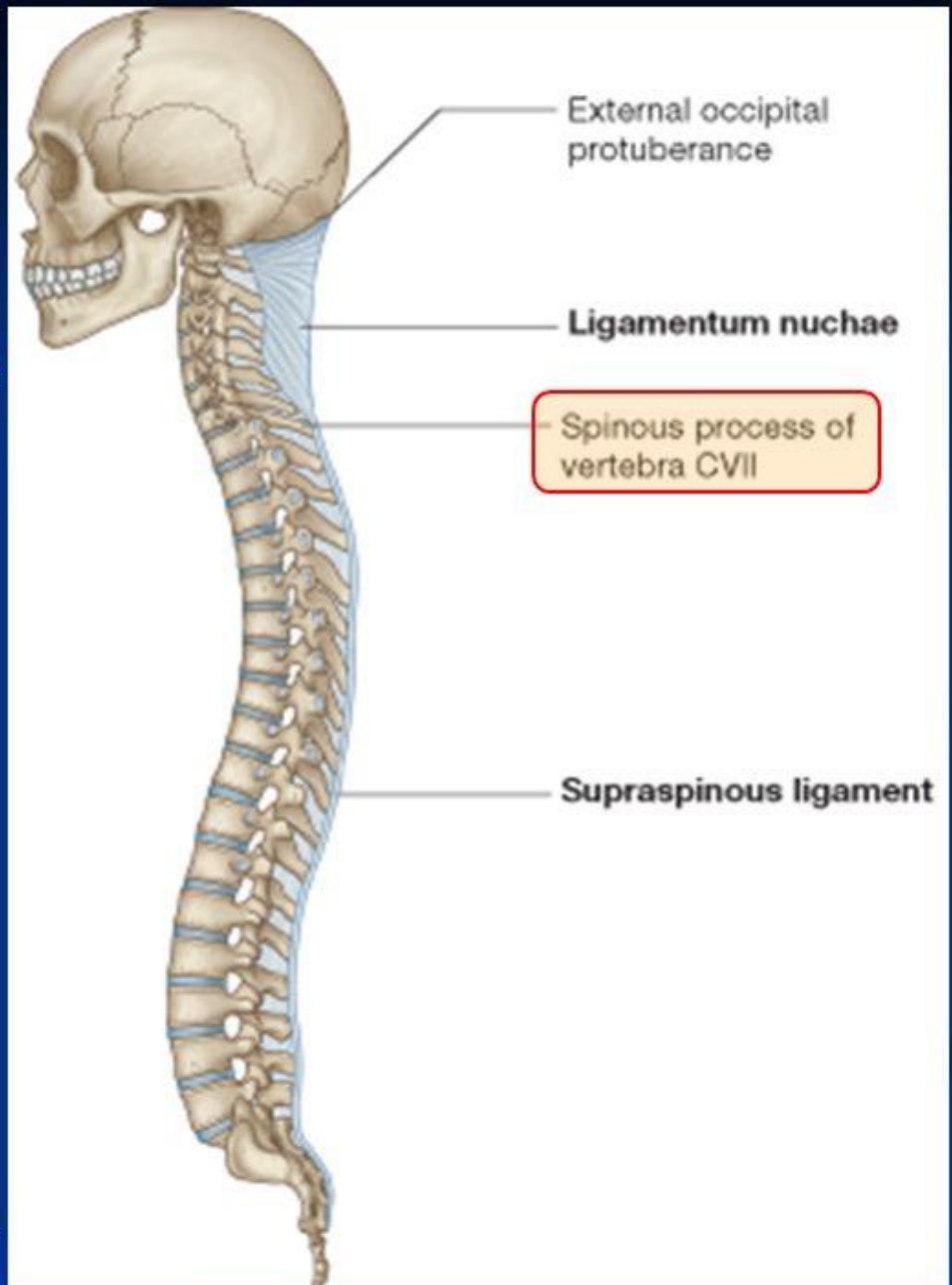
ANATOMY STANDARD

7th CERVICAL VERTEBRA OR Vertebra Prominens

It has the **longest** spinous process which is **not bifid**.

It is the **first spine** to be felt **subcutaneously** in the root of the back of the neck.

The transverse process is large with a small **foramen transversarium** or may be absent, and does not transmit the vertebral artery. (**only small accessory vein**)



LIGAMENTUM NUCHAE

- In the cervical region, the Supraspinous and Interspinous ligaments are greatly thickened to form the strong **ligamentum nuchae**.
- It extends from the spine of the seventh cervical vertebra to the external occipital protuberance of the skull, with its anterior border being strongly attached to the cervical spines in between.

